

Tuesday, 19 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light rain 17° 12°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 17° 10°	MANCHESTER Rain 17° 10°	GLASGOW Light rain 15° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The race to replace Starmer is on - but he still faces a momentous choice.

Labour is consumed by drama, but the PM still faces big decisions - and what could be his final choice.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Tube strikes called off by RMT union.

The Rail, Maritime and Transport (RMT) union calls off a series of 24-hour strikes starting on Tuesday.

UK · NEWS
- 3

Man 'fascinated by weapons' jailed after ninja sword and knuckle duster found.

Maximin Carter also stored an air rifle and four telescopic truncheons in his ex partner's house.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Shakira wins £50m tax refund from Spanish government.

The Colombian singer says the court ruling means the "narrative" that she was guilty now "crumbles".

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Lights, camera, Bangaranga: Highlights from Eurovision.

Bulgarian singer Dara stormed to victory in the contest, while Ukraine broke the record for the longest note ever sung at Eurovision.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

UK Eurovision act: The BBC gave me a stress test to check I could cope under pressure.

"It could go well or completely wrong, I'm just here for the ride," says song contest hopeful Sam Battle.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1 **England pass Six Nations stress test, but rivals will return.**

England have established a stranglehold on the women's Test game, but France, defeated in Sunday's Grand Slam decider, are potentially their most dangerous rival

SPORT · UK

2 **'I was screaming' - footballer stabbed seven times recalls mass knife attack.**

Footballer Jonathan Gjoshe was among the 11 passengers seriously injured in a knife attack on a train as it travelled through Cambridgeshire last November.

SPORT · UK

3 **How overperforming Villa returned to Champions League.**

Eight places better off than their expected position, Aston Villa are the highest overperforming team in the Premier League.

SPORT · UK

4 **Janse van Rensburg England call-up not right, says Care.**

Former England scrum-half Danny Care criticises the selection of South Africa-born Benhard Janse van Rensburg in the England training squad for this summer's Tests.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 2 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 3 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 4 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 5 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 6 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 7 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you won the lottery tonight, what's the FIRST thing you'd buy tomorrow?**

Talk-back: not the dream house. Not the holiday. The first daft thing you'd buy because you finally could.

- **What's the worst job you've ever had — and how long did you last?**

Talk-back: the war stories are usually the funniest. Bonus marks for under a fortnight.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A Yorkshire farmer has won a planning row by getting his prize-winning sheep listed as 'agricultural heritage', preventing a housing development from going ahead next to his field.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish café has started charging customers extra if they ask for the WiFi password before placing their order, claiming it 'improves table turnover by 40%'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£8.35 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£8.35 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 139 of the year, 226 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Calocerus (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Crispin of Viterbo; Christian feast day: Dunstan (Roman Catholic Church, Eastern Orthodox Church; commemoration, Anglicanism); Christian feast day: Ivo of Kermartin. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Gregory Poirier, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1968 — Kyle Eastwood, American actor and bass player
- 1940 — Mickey Newbury, American country/pop singer-songwriter (died 2002)
- 1992 — Heather Watson, British tennis player
- 1983 — Jessica Fox, English actress
- 1992 — Sam Smith, English singer-songwriter
- 1939 — Nancy Kwan, Hong Kong-American actress and makeup artist
- 1947 — Paul Brady, Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — President of Romania Traian Băsescu survives an impeachment referendum and returns to office from suspension.
- 2012 — A car bomb explodes near a military complex in the Syrian city of Deir ez-Zor, killing nine people.
- 2012 — Three gas cylinder bombs explode in front of a vocational school in the Italian city of Brindisi, killing one person and injuring five others.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1943 — Winston Churchill's second wartime address to the U.S. Congress
- 1959 — The North Vietnamese Army establishes Group 559, whose responsibility is to determine how to maintain supply lines to South Vietnam; the resulting route is the Ho Chi Minh trail.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1991 — Croats vote for independence in a referendum.
- 1963 — The New York Post Sunday Magazine publishes Martin Luther King Jr.'s Letter from Birmingham Jail.

- 2015 — The Refugio oil spill deposited 142,800 U.S. gallons (3,400 barrels) of crude oil onto an area in California considered one of the most biologically diverse coastlines of the west coast.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 140 of the year, 225 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abercius and Helena; Christian feast day: Alcuin of York; Christian feast day: Aurea of Ostia; Christian feast day: Austregisilus. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1958 — Jane Wiedlin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1961 — Clive Allen, English international footballer and manager
- 1946 — Cher, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1937 — Derek Lampe, English footballer
- 1970 — Louis Theroux, Singaporean-English journalist and producer
- 1960 — Tony Goldwyn, American actor and director
- 1986 — Dexter Blackstock, English footballer
- 1949 — Michèle Roberts, English author and poet

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1983 — Church Street bombing: A car bomb planted by UMkhonto we Sizwe explodes on Church Street in South Africa's capital, Pretoria, killing 19 people and injuring 217 others.
- 1985 — Radio Martí, part of the Voice of America service, begins broadcasting to Cuba.
- 1965 — One hundred twenty-one people are killed when Pakistan International Airlines Flight 705 crashes at Cairo International Airport.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2019 — The International System of Units (SI): The base units are redefined, making the international prototype of the kilogram obsolete.
- 1980 — In a referendum in Quebec, the population rejects, with 60% of the vote, a government proposal to move towards independence from Canada.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		